



» RANJI TROPHY

SHOWDOWN IN SURAT



Karnataka and Railways met in the group stage to produce an **exhilarating match up** at the Lalbhai Contractor Stadium in Surat, with Manish Pandey staying till the end to take the former home with just one wicket in hand.

Red-ball cricket has its fair share of naysayers. It is often dismissed as an appendage by a generation spoiled by the glam and glitter of the shortest format. But, given a fair contest between bat and ball, the players' skill and temperament being tested to the extreme is a spectacle in itself.

The 2024 Ranji Trophy group-stage encounter between Karnataka and Railways at the Lalbhai Contractor Stadium in Surat served up an edge-of-the-seat thriller, with the game swaying to and fro on the final day.

The Railways waded through the short-ball ploy employed on the third morning by Karnataka to set a target of 226 for the visitor.

The home team then brought forth its entire reserve of energy and more onto the field, closing down every run and cheering for every stop executed.

Every rap on the pad or play-and-miss was met with vociferous appeals,